

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF BRONX

-----X
SAMI DISU,

Plaintiff,

-against-

CITY OF NEW YORK and ALI HASSAN, JOHN OR
JANE DOE 1-10,

Defendants.
-----X

SUMMONS

Index No.

Plaintiff Designates Bronx County as
the Proper Venue for Trial

Venue is Based on Locus of Injury

TO THE ABOVE-NAMED DEFENDANTS:

YOU ARE HEREBY SUMMONED to answer the complaint in this action and to serve a copy of your answer, or if the complaint is not served with this summons, to serve a notice of appearance, on the Plaintiff's Attorney(s) within 20 days after the service of this summons, exclusive of the day of service (or within 30 days after the service is complete if this summons is not personally delivered to you within the State of New York); and in case of your failure to appear or answer, judgment will be taken against you by default for the relief demanded in the complaint.

Dated: Bayside, New York
March 24, 2022

SIM & DEPAOLA, LLP
Attorneys-at-Law
42-40 Bell Boulevard – Suite 405
Bayside, New York 11361
(718) 281-0400

By:



Sameer Nath, Esq.
Attorney for Plaintiff

TO: **CITY OF NEW YORK**

Via Corporation Counsel of the City of New York

100 Church Street

New York, New York 10007

POLICE OFFICER ALI HASSAN, Tax Id. No. 960642, Shield No. 1324

105th NYPD Precinct

92-08 222nd Street

Queens Village, New York, 11428

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF BRONX

-----X
SAMI DISU,

Plaintiff,

VERIFIED COMPLAINT

Index No.

-against-

CITY OF NEW YORK, ALI HASSAN and JOHN OR
JANE DOE 1-10,

Defendants.
-----X

Plaintiff, **SAMI DISU**, by and through the undersigned attorneys, **SIM & DEPAOLA, LLP**, for his complaint against the Defendants, **CITY OF NEW YORK, ALI HASSAN**, and **JOHN OR JANE DOE 1-10**, alleges and states as follows:

1. This is a civil rights action predicated on two claims, in which Plaintiff seeks relief *vis-à-vis* 42 U.S.C. §§ 1981, 1983, 1985, 1986 and 1988, the laws of the City and State of New York, in addition to the self-executing clauses or implied private causes of action within the constitution of State of New York, for the violations of his civil rights, as enumerated by the First, Fourth, Fifth, Sixth and Fourteenth Amendments to the Constitution of the United States, the New York State Constitution, in addition to the Laws of the City and State of New York.
2. The claims alleged herein arise from an incident occurring on, or about, June 4, 2020, when defendants, acting under color of state law, caused Plaintiff to be unlawfully stopped, questioned, searched, arrested, assaulted and detained in the vicinity of the intersection of 14th Street and 4th Avenue, New York, New York. As a result, Plaintiff was deprived of his liberty and suffered various physical, emotional and psychological injuries.

3. At all times here mentioned, defendants were acting under color of state law, to wit, under color of the statutes, ordinances, regulations, policies, customs and usages of the City and State of New York.

4. Plaintiff seeks monetary damages (compensatory and punitive) against defendants, an award of costs and reasonable attorney's fees, with all interest then accrued, together with such other or further relief, as this venerable Court may deem just and proper.

5. Defendant City of New York has been served with notice of the claims herein, pursuant to section 50-e of the New York General Municipal Law.

6. At least thirty (30) days have elapsed since the service of said notice and adjustment or payment thereof has been neglected or refused.

PARTIES

7. At all relevant times herein, Plaintiff, Sami Disu ("Mr. Disu"), is an adult Black or African American male, who presently resides in Bronx, New York.

8. Defendant, City of New York ("CITY"), is a municipal corporation duly organized and existing, under the laws of the State of New York.

9. At all relevant times herein, the New York City Police Department ("NYPD") was a wholly owned subsidiary which was further wholly operated, managed, maintained and controlled by Defendant CITY.

10. At all relevant times herein, Defendant CITY, acting through its New York City Police Department, was responsible for the policy, practice, supervision, implementation, and conduct of all NYPD matters and was responsible for the appointment, screening, hiring, training, supervision, discipline, retention and conduct of all NYPD personnel, including police officers,

detectives, investigators, sergeants, lieutenants and other supervisory officers or officials, as well as the individually named NYPD Defendants herein.

11. At all relevant times herein, Defendant CITY was responsible for enforcing the rules and regulations of the NYPD and for ensuring that the NYPD personnel obey the laws and constitutions and laws of the United States, State of New York and City of New York.

12. At all relevant times herein, Defendant, ALI HASSAN (“HASSAN”) was a Police Officer, supervisor, policy maker, or official employed by Defendant CITY by and through its NYPD under NYPD Shield No.: 1324 and Tax Id. No.: 960642, and as such, was acting as an agent, servant or employee of Defendant CITY. Defendant HASSAN is being sued in his individual and official capacities.

13. At all relevant times herein, Defendants, JOHN or JANE DOE 1-10 (“DOE 1-10”), were police officers, detectives, sergeants, supervisors, agents, associates, drivers, managers, policymakers or officials employed by the NYPD or CITY. At this time, Plaintiff does not know the true names, identities or tax registry numbers of Defendants DOE 1-10, as such knowledge is within the exclusive possession of Defendants. The names, DOE 1-10, are fictitious and are intended as placeholders for the employees, agents or other personnel, who caused to Plaintiff to be falsely arrested, assault, battered, or who subjected Plaintiff to excessive force or who aided, abetted, assisted or acted in concert with any other defendants to do the same.

14. The names JOHN or JANE DOE 1 – 10 are fictitious and meant as placeholders for the individual NYPD Defendants who (1) falsely arrested, (2) assaulted and battered and struck Plaintiff with their kinetic/ impact weapons, (3) maliciously prosecuted, and (4) handcuffed Plaintiff, who (5) failed to intervene to prevent the other Defendants from doing the same and who

(6) aided, abetted, assisted and acted in concert the other Defendants to commit the acts complained-of herein.

15. At all relevant times herein, Defendants DOE 1-10 were acting under color of state law, to wit, under color of the statutes, ordinances, regulations, policies, customs and usages of the City or State of New York.

FACTUAL CHARGES

16. On, or about, June 4, 2020, at approximately 9:30 p.m., Plaintiff was lawfully present in the vicinity of the intersection of 136th Street and Brook Avenue, The Bronx, New York.

17. At all times herein, Plaintiff was gainfully employed as a videographer.

18. A protest took place at said time, date and location.

19. Plaintiff was never observed or alleged to be committing any crimes or violations of the law and defendants, including HASSAN and JOHN OR JANE DOE 1-10, were not in possession of any information or evidence to the contrary.

20. At said date and time, Plaintiff was video recording the protest events.

21. Defendants, including HASSAN and JOHN OR JANE DOE 1-10, aggressively approached Plaintiff with outstretched arms holding weapons, despite lacking any indication, reasonable suspicion or probable cause to believe that Plaintiff was engaged in unlawful conduct.

22. Plaintiff retreated from Defendants, including HASSAN and JOHN OR JANE DOE 1-10.

23. Plaintiff assured Defendants, including HASSAN and JOHN OR JANE DOE 1-10, that he was present only to document the events unfolding and that he harbored no intent to participate or otherwise be complicit in any unlawful activities.

24. Defendants, including HASSAN and JOHN OR JANE DOE 1-10, violently struck Plaintiff with a baton, asp, nightstick, or other kinetic/ impact weapon numerous times about Plaintiff's

entire body, despite Plaintiff posing not immediate or future threat or menace to defendants, himself or anyone else.

25. Due to the lack of probable cause or reasonable suspicion to believe Plaintiff had committed, was committing or was about to commit a crime or violation of the law, the unconsented to physical contact initiated by defendants, including HASSAN and JOHN OR JANE DOE 1-10, constituted the completed torts of assault and battery.

26. Said assaults by, or at the direction of, defendants caused Plaintiff to suffer myriad injuries including, but not limited to, substantial physical pain, contusions, loss of range of movement, psychological trauma and emotional distress.

27. Due to the lack of probable cause, reasonable suspicion for a seizure of Plaintiff's person or property, said conduct constituted the completed torts of assault and battery by defendants, including DOE 1-10.

28. Plaintiff was illegally targeted for violent retaliation by defendants, including HASSAN and JOHN OR JANE DOE 1-10, because of his race, color, ethnicity or national origin, as defendants falsely accused, assaulted and battered Plaintiff because of their biased, prejudiced and otherwise impermissible feelings towards young Black or African American males, such as Plaintiff.

29. Upon information and belief, Defendants intentionally provided said false information to supervisory authorities and committees to evade disciplinary actions.

30. At no point did defendants, including HASSAN and JOHN OR JANE DOE 1-10, ever observe Plaintiff commit any crimes or offenses.

31. Defendants, including HASSAN and JOHN OR JANE DOE 1-10, retaliated against Plaintiff for exercising his right to record or otherwise document police interactions with the

general public, and therefore violated Plaintiff's right civil right to engage in protected speech or activities.

32. At all times relevant hereto, defendants, including HASSAN and JOHN OR JANE DOE 1-10, were involved in the decision to arrest Plaintiff without probable cause or failed to intervene when they observed others arresting Plaintiff without probable cause.

33. At all times relevant hereto, defendants, including HASSAN and JOHN OR JANE DOE 1-10, engaged in fraud, perjury, the suppression of evidence and other actions conducted in bad faith or failed to intervene when defendants observed others doing so, all in furtherance of Plaintiff's assaults.

34. Defendant CITY has engaged in a policy, custom, or pattern and practice of stopping vehicles occupied by members of protected classes, especially African Americans, without probable cause or reasonable suspicion to do so and then using excessive force in the process of unlawfully arresting said individuals.

35. Defendant CITY has also engaged in a policy, custom, or pattern and practice of concealing their unlawful arrests by fabricating false accounts that African American males were observed committing criminal acts, when no such acts were ever committed.

36. Plaintiff asserts that defendants, including HASSAN and JOHN OR JANE DOE 1-10, falsely arrested, assaulted, battered, and maliciously prosecuted him, due solely to their racial discriminatory prejudices against African Americans and their desire to satisfy an unconstitutional and unlawful arrest quota.

37. Plaintiff further asserts that Defendants, including HASSAN and JOHN OR JANE DOE 1-10, acted in such a sadistic and reprehensible manner, due to their assumption that defendants'

version of events would undoubtedly and unduly be credited over Plaintiff's, solely because Plaintiff is a young black, African American male.

38. Defendants, including HASSAN and JOHN OR JANE DOE 1-10, arrested, assaulted, battered Plaintiff, not because of any probable cause to believe Plaintiff had committed any crimes, violations of the law, but because Plaintiff is a young, African American male.

39. Defendants, including HASSAN and JOHN OR JANE DOE 1-10, discriminated against Plaintiff by arresting, assaulting, battering, Plaintiff, solely due to defendants' perception or consideration of Plaintiff's race, ethnicity, national origin, immigration status, religion, gender or age.

40. Defendants, including HASSAN and JOHN OR JANE DOE 1-10, perpetrated multiple overt acts in furtherance of their obviously discriminatory inclinations, namely the unlawful stop, searches, assaults, seizure, arrest and malicious prosecution against Plaintiff.

41. Defendants, including HASSAN and JOHN OR JANE DOE 1-10, possessed no valid reason to restrict Plaintiff's movements, which gives rise to the strong inference that the unlawful acts committed by defendants, including HASSAN and JOHN OR JANE DOE 1-10 against Plaintiff, were discriminatorily motivated and enacted upon.

42. Defendants, including HASSAN and JOHN OR JANE DOE 1-10 subjected Plaintiff to disparate treatment compared to other individuals similarly situated, because defendants do not question, arrest, assault, or batter White or Asian civilians recording said events.

43. Defendants, including HASSAN and JOHN OR JANE DOE 1-10, would not have arrested Plaintiff if Plaintiff was not a young African American male.

44. As a direct and proximate result of the acts of defendants, including HASSAN and JOHN OR JANE DOE 1-10, Plaintiff suffered the following injuries and damages: violations of his rights

pursuant to the Fourth and Fourteenth Amendments to the Constitution of the United States Constitution, violations of New York State law, physical injury, physical pain and suffering, emotional trauma and suffering, including fear, embarrassment, humiliation, emotional distress, frustration, extreme inconvenience, anxiety, loss of liberty and harm to reputation.

45. As a result, Plaintiff has suffered tremendous psychological trauma and emotional distress which is believed to be permanent.

46. As a result of Defendants actions, Plaintiff does not feel secured of his constitutional rights, which has prevented him from venturing from his house for a prolonged period of time and has effectively permanently chilled his desire and ability to communicate with police officers.

47. Plaintiff was an expectant parent on the date of incident. Upon information and belief, aforesaid acts have tarnished Plaintiff's memories of this particularly sacred time period in Plaintiff's life.

48. Defendant's acts have resulted in Plaintiff's psychological traumatization, as upon information and belief, Plaintiff was dehumanized, demoralized and humiliated Plaintiff.

49. Defendants, including HASSAN and JOHN OR JANE DOE 1-10, engaged in a conspiracy to personally confer with each other, regarding non-existent evidence and observations, as well the manner and means by which said fabrications would be forwarded to the District Attorney's Office.

50. Plaintiff asserts that the defendants, including HASSAN and JOHN OR JANE DOE 1-10, who violated Plaintiff's civil rights, are part of a larger pattern and practice of similar misconduct, which is so widespread, pervasive and consistent throughout the NYPD and the City of New York that the commission such constitutionally violative behavior has become tantamount to an official policy or custom within the NYPD and City of New York or, at the very least, conclusive evidence

that the City and the NYPD have either tacitly approved of such egregious wrongdoings or that they have become deliberately indifferent to the civil rights of those who may come into contact with their police officers.

51. The individually named defendants herein, as well as other officers serving in the employ of the NYPD and City of New York, have blatantly, shamelessly, consistently and repeatedly engaged in conduct violative of the civil rights guaranteed and protected by Constitution of the United States, in addition to the laws and Constitution of the State of New York, all without incurring any ramifications for such misconduct and, ostensibly, with the full and complete blessing of the NYPD, the City of New York and their respective policymakers and supervisors.

52. *The New York Times*, as well as numerous other reputable journalistic enterprises, have reported on the widespread corruption within the NYPD and City of New York, particularly the incredibly disconcerting proclivity of many NYPD officers to lie about subject matters that are materially relevant to criminal prosecutions, including the complete fabrication of arrest evidence and witnesses. Also detailed, is the NYPD's obstinate refusal to effectuate corrective or preventive measures to combat the inevitable recurrence of such misdeeds, and perhaps most troubling, the NYPD's alarming tendency to, instead, reward and promote these officers, including those who were inculcated via incontrovertible evidence, such as video evidence.

53. The constitutionally repugnant behavior that persists within the ranks of the NYPD results from the NYPD's own policies, rules and procedures, namely the NYPD's incredibly flawed and illegal use of arrest quotas. Despite its illegality, such policies remain systemin throughout the NYPD and its individual commands. The NYPD, however, was not content in compelling its officers to effect as many arrests as possible, regardless of the presence of any legal right to do, it promulgated various subsets of quotas, which are predicated on race, color or ethnicity.

Additionally, the NYPD, its supervisors or policymakers would assign varying point values to arrests, which were, again, impermissibly based upon the arrestee's race, color or ethnicity. Unsurprisingly, officers would be better rewarded for minority arrests or summonses. This egregious conduct has reported by numerous respected media outlets and publications and has even formed the basis for federal lawsuits against the City and the NYPD, which were commenced by its own employee officers.

54. On June 17, 2020, the *New York Daily News* published an article, by Graham Rayman, entitled "Brooklyn Cop Claims he was Punished for not Meeting Arrest Quotas, Refusing to Take Responsibility for Controversial Arrest in which he Wasn't Involved," describing allegations from an NYPD Police Officer, Terrence Dickerson, that he was retaliated against by the NYPD for refusing to adhere to mandatory racially based arrest quotas and for his refusal to accept responsibility for a controversial and publicized arrest via the excessive force, despite the fact that he was not even at the scene.

55. Another article with a title that speaks for itself, also published by the *New York Daily News*, on December 5, 2019, and written by Graham Rayman, is entitled "Ex-Cop Details NYPD 'Collar Quotas'—Arrest Black and Hispanic Men, 'No Cuffs on Soft Targets' of Jews, Asians, Whites: Court Docs."

56. *The New York Times*, on December 6, 2019, published an article by Joseph Goldstein and Ashley Southall, entitled "I Got Tired of Hunting Black and Hispanic People," which revealed a disturbing account from a different NYPD Police Officer, Anthony Diaz, describing a police force that measures the quality of police work by the quantity of minority arrests.

57. On March 18, 2018, *The New York Times* published an explosive article, entitled "Promotions, Not Punishments for Officers Accused of Lying," written by Joseph Goldstein. Mr.

Goldstein shines a light on the multitude of flaws within the CCRB and the NYPD, highlighting the fact that the substantiation of a claim against an officer will invariably rely on the presence of incontrovertible proof against the officer. Due to the rarity availability of this type of evidence, an alarmingly small percentage of officer misconduct claims are substantiated. The CCRB is further handicapped by a terribly designed system that requires evidence of a virtually indisputable nature to substantiate any claim against an officer. The article also details the NYPD's persistent reluctance to investigate or discipline officers who lie and even posits that this reluctance is a significant cause of the lying pandemic within the NYPD. The article references various officers and detectives who were the subject of credible accusations relating to the officers' intentionally false statements, with some allegations coming from federal and state judges.

58. On September 12, 2019, *The New York Times* published another article by Joseph Goldstein, entitled "Officers Said They Smelled Pot. The Judge Called Them Liars." Unsurprisingly, this article dealt with the unusually high frequency of officers using the odor of marijuana to excuse a search that conspicuously does not result in the recovery of any marijuana. It should not require an article in *The New York Times* to call attention to such patently disingenuous tactics, but has become necessary for a variety of reasons, including the NYPD's failure to correct such behavior, the willingness of prosecutors and judges to credit the lying officers and the increasing rate of occurrence.

59. On April 24, 2019, *The New York Times* published an article, entitled "Detective's Lies Sent Three People to Prison, Prosecutors Charge," by Sean Piccolo, detailing the lies of NYPD Second Grade Detective Joseph Franco and how those lies resulted in the imprisonment of at least three innocent people. The article described how Det. Franco lied about observing drug transactions on at least three separate occasions, lies that were only uncovered through

contradictory video evidence. Det. Franco's lies resulted in the innocent individuals each being sentenced to prison terms in excess of one-year.

60. Other articles include: (i) "Testilying' by Police: A Stubborn Problem.," by Joseph Goldstein, *The New York Times*, March 18, 2018; (ii) "New York Detective Charged with Faking Lineup Results," by Joseph Goldstein, *The New York Times*, February 17, 2018; (iii) "He Excelled as a Detective, Until Prosecutors Stopped Believing Him," by Joseph Goldstein, *The New York Times*, October 17, 2017; (iv) "Review Board Notes Rise in New York Police Officers' False Statement," by J. David Goodman, *The New York Times*, May 14, 2015; (v) "In Brooklyn Gun Cases, Suspicion Turns to the Police," by Stephanie Clifford, *The New York Times*, December 11, 2014; (vi) "Detective is Found Guilty of Planting Drugs," by Tim Stelloh, *The New York Times*, November 1, 2011; and (vii) "The Drugs? They Came from the Police," by Jim Dwyer, *The New York Times*, October 13, 2011.

61. The NYPD has a longstanding and ignominious record of failing to discipline its officers, or even entertaining allegations of wrongdoing against them. On June 26, 2019, *The New York Times* published an article, entitled "2,495 Reports of Police Bias. Not One Was Deemed Valid by the N.Y.P.D." This article reported that within the last five (5) years, almost 2,500 separate individuals have filed formal complaints with the NYPD alleging that an officer acted with bias toward them, with not a single one being substantiated by the NYPD. Such a finding is plainly incredible and obviously the result of deliberately poor or nonexistent investigatory protocols. The report further impugned the NYPD's commitment to combat the prejudices and the biases exhibited by many of its officers.

62. Upon information and belief, the NYPD, the City of New York, and their respective policymakers, officials or supervisors have imposed, tacitly approved or acquiesced to policies,

customs, or patterns and practices within the NYPD that resulted in Plaintiff's arrest without probable cause.

63. Upon information and belief, the NYPD, the City of New York, and their respective policymakers or supervisors have failed to provide adequate training regarding the identification of probable cause, reasonable suspicion or the appropriate amount of force to be used.

64. Defendants' actions, pursuant to Plaintiff's underlying arrest, which occurred without even the semblance of probable cause, were so blatantly violative of Plaintiff's civil rights that the tacit approval of identical or similar acts by the policymakers or supervisors of the NYPD and the City of New York, as well as their deliberate indifference towards the rights of any individuals who may come into contact with Defendants, should be inferred, because such flagrant deprivations of constitutionally protected rights could not and would not occur without the tacit approval or deliberate indifference regarding the commission of such violations by the policymakers or supervisors of the NYPD and City of New York.

65. Upon information and belief, further details and facts, relating to the unlawful policies, customs or patterns and practices of the NYPD, City of New York and their respective policymakers, supervisors, police officers or employees, will become known after the completion of discovery, as such information is presently within the exclusive possession of Defendants, the NYPD and City of New York.

66. Upon information and belief, the personnel files, records and disciplinary histories of the officer Defendants will reveal a history of Constitutional violations indicative of Defendant City's knowledge that the individual officer Defendants were unfit for employment as NYPD officers, or for employment in general, and that the probability of the individually named Defendants committing similar violations in the future was extremely high.

67. Upon information and belief, said personnel files, records and disciplinary histories will conclusively show that the City and the NYPD were fully aware of Defendants' past constitutional violations, the unacceptably high probability for the recurrence of similar transgressions, the unreasonably dangerous situations that were likely to result from their hiring or retention, as well as their unsuitability for employment as law enforcement officers, or for employment in general, and that the NYPD and City of New York failed to engage in any preventive or corrective action intended to diminish the likelihood of recurrence for such violations, which is tantamount to the City's tacit approval of such misconduct or the City's deliberate indifference towards the civil rights of those who may interact with its employees, including the above-named defendants.

68. Upon information and belief, the NYPD and City of New York and have failed, or outright refused, to correct the individually named Defendants' predilections to engage in unconstitutional behavior or attempt to prevent the recurrence of such misconduct.

69. The aforementioned acts of defendants, including HASSAN and JOHN OR JANE DOE 1-10, directly or proximately resulted in the deprivation or violation of Plaintiff's civil rights, as guaranteed and protected by the First, Fourth, Fifth, Sixth or Fourteenth Amendments to the United States Constitution, as well as the laws and constitution of the State of New York.

70. As a direct or proximate result of said acts, Plaintiff was caused to suffer the loss of his liberty, irreparable reputational harm, loss of earnings and potential earnings, physical injury, as well as severe and permanent emotional distress, including fear, embarrassment, humiliation, traumatization, frustration, extreme inconvenience and anxiety.

FIRST CAUSE OF ACTION

Freedom of Speech Retaliation Claim Under
New York State Law

71. The above paragraphs are hereby incorporated by reference as though fully set forth herein.

72. Plaintiff engaged in speech and activities that were protected by section 8, of Article I to the constitution of the State of New York.

73. Defendants committed impermissible or unlawful actions against Plaintiff that were motivated or substantially caused by Plaintiff's constitutionally protected speech or activities.

74. Defendants' retaliatory actions against Plaintiff resulted in the deprivation of his liberty and the initiation of criminal charges against him.

75. Defendants' retaliatory actions adversely affected Plaintiff's protected speech or activities by physically or procedurally preventing him from further pursuing said protected speech or activities or by chilling him desire to further participate or engage in such protected speech or activities.

76. Accordingly, Plaintiff's right to engage in protected speech and activities, guaranteed and protected by section 8, of Article I to the constitution of the State of New York, was violated by Defendants.

77. Defendant City, as employer of the individual Defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoings, under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

78. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.

SECOND CAUSE OF ACTION

First Amendment Retaliation Claim Under
42 U.S.C. § 1983 *Against* Individual NYPD Defendants

79. The above paragraphs are hereby incorporated by reference as though fully set forth herein.

80. Plaintiff engaged in speech and activities that were protected by the First Amendment to the United States Constitution.

81. Defendants committed impermissible or unlawful actions against Plaintiff that were motivated or substantially caused by Plaintiff's constitutionally protected speech or activities.

82. Defendants' retaliatory actions against Plaintiff resulted in the deprivation of his liberty and the initiation of criminal charges against him.

83. Defendants' retaliatory actions adversely affected Plaintiff's protected speech or activities by physically or procedurally preventing him from further pursuing said protected speech or activities, or by chilling his desire to further participate or engage in such protected speech or activities.

84. Accordingly, Plaintiff's right to engage in protected speech and activities, as guaranteed and protected by the First Amendment to the United States Constitution, was violated by Defendants.

85. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.

THIRD CAUSE OF ACTION
Unlawful Search & Seizure Under
New York State Law

86. The above paragraphs are hereby incorporated by reference as though fully set forth herein.

87. Defendants subjected Plaintiff and his property to unreasonable searches and seizures without a valid warrant and without reasonable suspicion or probable cause do so.

88. Plaintiff was conscious and fully aware of the unreasonable searches and seizures to his person and property.

89. Plaintiff did not consent to the unreasonable searches and seizures to his person or property.

90. The unreasonable searches and seizures to Plaintiff's person and property were not otherwise privileged.

91. Accordingly, Defendants violated Plaintiff's right to be free from unreasonable searches and seizures, pursuant to section 12, of Article I to the constitution of the State of New York and section 8, Article II, of the New York Civil Rights Law.

92. Defendants CITY as employers of the individual Defendants, are responsible for their wrongdoings under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

93. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.

FOURTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Unlawful Search & Seizure Under

42 U.S.C. § 1983 *Against* Individual NYPD Defendants

94. The above paragraphs are hereby incorporated by reference as though fully set forth herein.

95. Defendants subjected Plaintiff and her property to unreasonable searches and seizures without a valid warrant and without reasonable suspicion or probable cause do so.

96. Plaintiff was conscious and fully aware of the unreasonable searches and seizures to his person and property.

97. Plaintiff did not consent to the unreasonable searches and seizures to his person or property.

98. The unreasonable searches and seizures to Plaintiff's person and property were not otherwise privileged.

99. Accordingly, Defendants violated Plaintiff's right to be free from unreasonable searches and seizures, pursuant to the Fourth Amendment to the United States Constitution.

100. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.

FIFTH CAUSE OF ACTIONFalse Arrest & False Imprisonment Under
New York State Law

101. The above paragraphs are hereby incorporated by reference as though fully set forth herein.
102. Defendants subjected Plaintiff to false arrest, false imprisonment, and deprivation of liberty without a valid warrant or probable cause.
103. Plaintiff was conscious of his confinement.
104. Plaintiff did not consent to his confinement.
105. Plaintiff's arrest and false imprisonment was not otherwise privileged.
106. Defendants CITY as employers of the individual Defendants, are responsible for their wrongdoings under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.
107. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.

SIXTH CAUSE OF ACTIONFalse Arrest & False Imprisonment Under
42 U.S.C. § 1983 *Against* Individual Defendants

108. The above paragraphs are hereby incorporated by reference as though fully set forth herein.
109. The Defendants violated the Fourth and Fourteenth Amendments to the Constitution of the United States by wrongfully and illegally arresting, detaining and imprisoning Plaintiff.
110. The wrongful, unjustifiable, and unlawful apprehension, arrest, detention, and imprisonment of Plaintiff was carried out without a valid warrant, without Plaintiff's consent, and without probable cause or reasonable suspicion.
111. At all relevant times, Defendants acted forcibly in apprehending, arresting, and imprisoning Plaintiff.

112. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.

SEVENTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Assault & Battery Under
New York State Law

113. The above paragraphs are hereby incorporated by reference as though fully set forth herein.

114. At all relevant times, Defendants caused Plaintiff to fear for his physical well-being and safety and placed him in apprehension of immediate harmful and/or offensive touching.

115. Defendants engaged in and subjected Plaintiff to immediate harmful or offensive touching and battered him without his consent or justification.

116. Due to the intentional, willful and unlawful acts of Defendants, Plaintiff suffered damages.

117. Defendants CITY as employers of the individual Defendants, are responsible for their wrongdoings under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

118. As a direct and proximate result of this breach, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.

EIGHTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Excessive Force Under
42 U.S.C. § 1983 *Against* Individual NYPD Defendants

119. The above paragraphs are hereby incorporated by reference as though fully set forth herein.

120. The Defendants violated Plaintiff's rights under the Fourth and Fourteenth Amendments, because they used unreasonable force without Plaintiff's consent.

121. Defendants engaged in and subjected Plaintiff to immediate harmful or offensive touching and battered him without his consent.

122. As a direct and proximate result of this breach, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.

NINTH CAUSE OF ACTION**Unlawful Interference with Recording a Law Enforcement Activity Under
New York State Law**

123. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth.

124. Plaintiff, while not under arrest or in the custody of a law enforcement official, was lawfully recording law enforcement activity without physically interfering with law enforcement activity or otherwise constituting a crime defined in the penal law involving obstructing governmental administration.

125. Defendants unlawfully interfered with Plaintiff's right to record law enforcement activity by threatening plaintiff for recording such activity, commanding Plaintiff to cease recording, stopping, seizing, searching, ticketing or arresting plaintiff for recording, or unlawfully seizing property or instruments used by that person to record, unlawfully destroying, or seizing a recorded image, or copying such a recording without the consent of Plaintiff or approval from an appropriate court.

126. Accordingly, Plaintiff's right to record law enforcement activities, pursuant to Section 79-P of the New York Civil Rights Law, was violated by defendants.

127. Defendant City, as employer of the individual Defendants, is responsible for their wrongdoings, under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

128. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.

TENTH CAUSE OF ACTION**Biased Based Profiling Under
New York City Law**

129. The above paragraphs are hereby incorporated by reference as though fully set forth herein.

130. Defendants impermissibly relied upon Plaintiff's actual or perceived race, color, national origin, ancestry, citizenship status, gender, religion, religious practice, age, disability or sexual orientation, as the determinative factor in initiating law enforcement action against Plaintiff, rather than Plaintiff's behavior or other information or circumstances that would link Plaintiff to suspected unlawful activity.

131. Accordingly, defendants violated Plaintiff's rights, pursuant to section 14-151 of the Administrative Code of the City of New York.

132. Defendants City as employers of the individual Defendants, are responsible for their wrongdoings under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

133. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.

ELEVENTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Deprivation of Rights & Denial of Equal Protection of the Laws Under New York State Law

134. The above paragraphs are hereby incorporated by reference as though fully set forth herein.

135. Plaintiff, as a Black or African American male, is a member of a racial minority and protected class.

136. Defendants discriminated against Plaintiff on the basis of his race, color, national origin, ancestry, gender, religion, religious practice, age, disability or sexual orientation.

137. Defendants also engaged in the selective treatment of Plaintiff, in comparison to others similarly situated.

138. Defendants' discriminatory treatment of Plaintiff was based on impermissible considerations, such as race, color, ethnicity, an intent to inhibit or punish Plaintiff for the exertion of his Constitutional rights, or a malicious or bad faith intent to injure Plaintiff.

139. Defendants applied facially neutral laws against Plaintiff in a discriminatory manner.

140. Defendants, motivated by discriminatory animus, applied facially neutral statutes with adverse effects against Plaintiff.

141. Defendants did not possess a rational basis, excuse or justification for applying any laws or statutes against Plaintiff.

142. Accordingly, Defendants violated Plaintiff's rights, pursuant to section 11, Article I, of the New York Constitution, section 79-N, Article VII, of the New York Civil Rights Law and paragraph 13, section 296, of the New York Executive Law.

143. Defendants City, as employers of the individual Defendants, are responsible for their wrongdoings under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

144. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.

TWELFTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Deprivation of Rights & Denial of Equal Protection of the Laws Under
42 U.S.C. §§ 1981 & 1983 *Against* Individual Defendants

145. The above paragraphs are hereby incorporated by reference as though fully set forth herein.

146. Plaintiff, as a Black or African American male, is a member of a racial minority and protected class.

147. Defendants discriminated against Plaintiff on the basis of race, color or ethnicity.

148. Defendants engaged in the selective treatment of Plaintiff in comparison to others similarly situated.

149. Defendants' selective treatment of Plaintiff was based on impermissible considerations, such as race, color, ethnicity, an intent to inhibit or punish Plaintiff for the exertion of his Constitutional rights, or malicious or bad faith intent to injure Plaintiff.

150. Defendants applied facially neutral laws against Plaintiff in a discriminatory manner.

151. Defendants, motivated by a discriminatory animus, applied facially neutral penal statutes with adverse effects against Plaintiff.

152. Defendants did not possess a rational basis, excuse or justification for applying any laws or statutes against Plaintiff.

153. Defendants City, as employers of the individual Defendants, are responsible for their wrongdoings under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

154. Accordingly, Defendants violated Plaintiff's rights, under the Fourteenth Amendment.

155. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.

THIRTEENTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Conspiracy to Interfere with Civil Rights & Failure to Prevent the Conspiracy Under
42 U.S.C. §§ 1983, 1985 & 1986 *Against* Individual Defendants

156. The above paragraphs are hereby incorporated by reference as though fully set forth herein.

157. Defendants engaged in a conspiracy against Plaintiff to deprive Plaintiff of his rights to engage in protected speech or activities, to be free from unreasonable searches and seizures, to be afforded a fair trial, to not be deprived of his liberty or property without due process of law, or of the privileges and immunities under the laws and constitutions of the United States and of the State of New York.

158. Defendants committed overt acts in furtherance of their conspiracy against Plaintiff.

159. As a result, Plaintiff sustained injuries to his person, was deprived of his liberty or was deprived of rights or privileges of citizens of the United States.

160. Defendants' conspiracy was motivated by a desire to deprive Plaintiff of his civil rights or because of some racial, otherwise class-based, invidious or discriminatory animus.

161. The Defendants that did not engage or participate in the conspiracy to interfere with Plaintiff's civil rights, had knowledge that acts in furtherance of the conspiracy were about to be committed or in process of being committed, possessed the power to prevent or aid in the prevention of the conspiratorial objective, and neglected to do so.

162. Accordingly, Defendants violated Plaintiff's rights, pursuant to the First, Fourth, Fifth, Sixth or Fourteenth Amendments to the United States Constitution.

163. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.

FOURTEENTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Failure to Intervene Under
New York State Law

164. The above paragraphs are here incorporated by reference as though fully set forth herein.

165. Those Defendants that were present but did not actively participate in the aforementioned unlawful conduct, observed such conduct, had an opportunity to prevent such conduct, had a duty to intervene and prevent such conduct, and failed to intervene.

166. Defendants City, as employers of the individual Defendants, are responsible for their wrongdoings under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

167. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.

FIFTEENTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Failure to Intervene Under
42 U.S.C. § 1983 *Against* Individual Defendants

168. The above paragraphs are hereby incorporated by reference as though fully set forth herein.

169. Those defendants that were present but did not actively participate in the aforementioned unlawful conduct observed such conduct, had an opportunity to prevent such conduct, had a duty to intervene and prevent such conduct, and failed to intervene.

170. Accordingly, the defendants who failed to intervene violated the First, Fourth, Fifth, Sixth or Fourteenth Amendments.

171. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.

SIXTEENTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Negligent Hiring, Training, Retention or Supervision Under
New York State Law

172. The above paragraphs are hereby incorporated by reference as though fully set forth herein.

173. Defendants CITY owed duties of care to Plaintiff to adequately hire, train, retain or supervise their employees, including the individually named defendants herein.

174. Defendants CITY breached those duties of care.

175. Defendants CITY placed the individually named defendants in positions they could inflict foreseeable harm.

176. Defendants CITY knew or should have known of that their employees, including the individually named defendants herein, exhibited substantial propensities for committing civil rights violations against members of the public, such as Plaintiff.

177. Defendants CITY failed to take reasonable measures in hiring, training, retaining or supervising their employees, including the individually named defendants herein, that would have prevented the aforesaid injuries to Plaintiff.

178. where

179. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.

SEVENTEENTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Violation of Victims of Violent Crime Protection Act Under
New York City Law

180. The above paragraphs are hereby incorporated by reference as though fully set forth herein.

181. Defendants' acts or series of acts constituted a misdemeanor or felony against Plaintiff, as defined in state or federal law which presented a serious risk of physical injury to Plaintiff, whether or not such acts have actually resulted in criminal charges, prosecution or conviction.

182. Accordingly, Defendants committed a crime of violence against Plaintiff and violated Plaintiff's rights, pursuant to the section 10-403 of the Administrative Code of the City of New York.

183. Defendants City as employers of the individual Defendants, are responsible for their wrongdoings under the doctrine of *respondeat superior*.

184. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.

EIGHTEENTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Municipal "*Monell*" Liability Under
42 U.S.C. § 1983 *Against* Defendant City

185. The above paragraphs are hereby incorporated by reference as though fully set forth herein.

186. Defendant City maintained a policy or custom that caused Plaintiff to be deprived of his civil rights, tacitly approved of such violative conduct or was deliberately indifferent toward the potential exposure of individuals, such as Plaintiff, to such violative behavior.

187. Defendant City's employee police officers have engaged in an illegal pattern and practice of misconduct, so consistent and widespread that it constitutes a custom or usage, of which a supervisor or policymaker must have been aware of.

188. Defendant City, its policymakers and supervisors failed to provide adequate training or supervision to their subordinates, to such an extent that is tantamount to the City's deliberate indifference toward the rights of those who may come into contact with Defendant City's employees.

189. Defendant City's employees engaged in such egregious and flagrant violations of Plaintiff's Constitutional rights that the need for enhanced training or supervision is obvious and equates to a display of deliberate indifference by Defendant City and its policymakers toward the rights of individuals, who may come into contact with Defendant City's employees.

190. Defendant City's repeated refusal or failure to install or apply corrective or preventive measures constitutes the tacit approval of such violative behavior or a deliberate indifference to the rights of those who may be affected by such behavior.

191. Defendant City's conduct caused Plaintiff to be deprived of his civil rights, as guaranteed by the Constitution of the United States *vis-à-vis* the First, Fourth, Fifth, Sixth or Fourteenth Amendments thereto.

192. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, Plaintiff sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.

WHEREFORE, Plaintiff respectfully requests judgment against defendants, jointly and severally, as follows:

- a) On the First Cause of Action, in a sum of money having a present value exceeding the jurisdictional limits of all lower courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction of this matter;
- b) On the Second Cause of Action, in a sum of money having a present value exceeding the jurisdictional limits of all lower courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction of this matter;

- c) On the Third Cause of Action, in a sum of money having a present value exceeding the jurisdictional limits of all lower courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction of this matter;
- d) On the Fourth Cause of Action, in a sum of money having a present value exceeding the jurisdictional limits of all lower courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction of this matter;
- e) On the Fifth Cause of Action, in a sum of money having a present value exceeding the jurisdictional limits of all lower courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction of this matter;
- f) On the Sixth Cause of Action, in a sum of money having a present value exceeding the jurisdictional limits of all lower courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction of this matter;
- g) On the Seventh Cause of Action, in a sum of money having a present value exceeding the jurisdictional limits of all lower courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction of this matter;
- h) On the Eighth Cause of Action, in a sum of money having a present value exceeding the jurisdictional limits of all lower courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction of this matter;
- i) On the Ninth Cause of Action, in a sum of money having a present value exceeding the jurisdictional limits of all lower courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction of this matter;
- j) On the Tenth Cause of Action, in a sum of money having a present value exceeding the jurisdictional limits of all lower courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction of this matter;
- k) On the Eleventh Cause of Action, in a sum of money having a present value exceeding the jurisdictional limits of all lower courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction of this matter;
- l) On the Twelfth Cause of Action, in a sum of money exceeding the jurisdictional limits of all lower courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction of this matter;
- m) On the Thirteenth Cause of Action, in a sum of money exceeding the jurisdictional limits of all lower courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction of this matter;

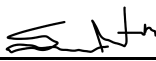
- n) On the Fourteenth Cause of Action, in a sum of money exceeding the jurisdictional limits of all lower courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction of this matter;
- o) On the Fifteenth Cause of Action, in a sum of money exceeding the jurisdictional limits of all lower courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction of this matter;
- p) On the Sixteenth Cause of Action, in a sum of money exceeding the jurisdictional limits of all lower courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction of this matter;
- q) On the Seventeenth Cause of Action, in a sum of money exceeding the jurisdictional limits of all lower courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction of this matter;
- r) On the Eighteenth Cause of Action, in a sum of money exceeding the jurisdictional limits of all lower courts which would otherwise have jurisdiction of this matter;
- s) Awarding Plaintiff punitive damages in an amount to be determined by a jury on all causes of action set forth herein;
- t) Awarding Plaintiff reasonable attorney's fees and costs, pursuant to 42 U.S.C. § 1988, the New York Civil Rights and Executive Laws, in addition to the Administrative Code of the City of New York; together with the costs and disbursements of this action.

JURY DEMAND

Plaintiff hereby demands a trial by jury.

Dated: Bayside, New York
March 24, 2022

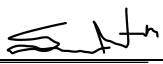
SIM & DEPAOLA, LLP
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(718) 281-0400

By: 
Sameer Nath, Esq.
Attorney for Plaintiff

ATTORNEY VERIFICATION

I, Sameer Nath, Esq. an attorney admitted to practice in the courts of New York State, state that I am a partner with the firm of Sim & DePaola, LLP, the attorneys of record for Plaintiff in the within action; I have read the foregoing and know the contents thereof; the same is true to my own knowledge, except as to the matters therein stated to be alleged on information and belief, and as to those matters I believe it to be true. The reason this verification is made by me and not by Plaintiff, because Plaintiff resides outside the county where deponent maintains his office. I affirm that the foregoing statements are true, under the penalties of perjury.

Dated: Bayside, New York
March 24, 2022



Sameer Nath, Esq.